

Group Proposal Presentation — Guide

Foundations of Clinical Research: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata — *#ClearDataClearImpact*

When: Session 8 (weekend 4, Sunday), the 45-minute presentation block after "Be the reviewer"

Format: **6 minutes, 6 slides** on your research proposal and publication plan, then **2 minutes** of structured feedback; at the end of the block, a **1-minute manuscript pitch** per group

Content: Group product 1 (proposal, your own question) in the 6 minutes; Group product 2 (manuscript, course dataset) in the 1-minute pitch

Marked with: the presentation section of [Proposal_Rubric.pdf](#) (criteria 12–16)

0. How the 45 minutes are used

Part	Time	What
Group presentations	5 groups × (6 min + 2 min feedback) = 40 min	Proposal and publication plan on your own question (sections 1–4 below)
Manuscript round	5 groups × 1 min = 5 min	Each group's manuscript pitch on its FLUID-ICU question (section 5 below)
Total	45 min	Followed directly by the post-course quiz in the last 15 minutes of Session 8

The manuscript is **not** part of the 6 minutes: keep the two products separate so that the proposal gets its full time and the rubric (criteria 12–16) applies to the proposal only.

1. The six slides

One slide ≈ one minute. Slide 1 is quick, which leaves a little extra time for slides 3 and 4.

Slide	Title	What to show	Time
1	Title & team	Working title; group number; names, professions and roles; one photo or icon of the clinical problem (optional).	0:20
2	Problem & PICO	The problem in one sentence with one number (how common or how serious); the PICO as a 4-row table; the research question; the hypothesis.	1:00
3	Design & participants	Design and why; setting; key inclusion/exclusion criteria; a simple flow picture (eligible → enrolled → groups → outcome); the main bias and how you reduce it.	1:15
4	Data & analysis plan	Primary outcome (how and when measured); 4–6 key variables with types; how data are captured and checked; sample size statement; which summary and which test or model; how you will handle missing data.	1:15
5	Ethics & feasibility	Consent approach; registration; confidentiality; a simple timeline (Gantt bar); expected recruitment per month; the biggest practical risk and your plan for it.	1:00
6	Publication plan & impact	Target journal and the reporting guideline you will follow; working title; authors with their CRediT roles; one line of the abstract skeleton (e.g. the Conclusion you would write for each possible result); what will change for patients or the unit.	1:10
		Total	6:00

Use the course slide template if one is provided, or any plain template with a light background and dark text.

2. Tips for a good presentation

Content

- **One message per slide.** The slide title can be the message ("A cohort study is the realistic design here").
- **Maximum ~6 short lines** per slide, at least 24-point font. If you need to read it, the audience cannot.
- **Pictures before words** — a PICO table, a flow diagram and a timeline bar are clearer than paragraphs.
- **Numbers with units and sources** ("about 40 septic shock admissions per year, unit register").
- **Be honest about weaknesses.** Naming your main bias and limitation scores marks; hiding it loses them.
- **Use calibrated language** on slide 6: an observational study can show an *association*, not prove a cause.
- Make sure the slides match the written proposal (same question, same primary outcome, same sample size, same working title).

Delivery

- Rehearse at least twice **with a timer**. Six minutes is short: most groups overrun on slide 2 — keep the background brief.

- Speak to the room, not to the screen. Point to the one thing on the slide that matters.
- If several members present, plan the hand-overs ("Now our methods lead will explain how we will collect the data").
- Avoid jargon you could not explain to a new colleague. Plain language is a strength.
- Prepare for three likely questions: "Why this design?", "Can you really recruit that many patients?" and "Why this journal?"
- Do not mix in the FLUID-ICU manuscript; it has its own minute at the end.

Technical

- Send the file to the course lead the evening before Session 8 (see [Proposal_Brief.pdf](#)); bring a copy on a USB stick.
- Do not embed videos or rely on internet access.
- Check that tables and the Gantt chart are readable from the back of the room.

3. Timekeeping — coloured cards

A timekeeper (an instructor or a member of another group) sits in the front row with three cards and a timer.

Card	Shown at	Meaning
Green	4:00	2 minutes left — you should be on slide 5.
Yellow	5:00	1 minute left — move to your final slide.
Red	6:00	Time is up — finish your sentence and stop.

At **6:30** the chair stops the presentation politely, even mid-slide. Keeping to time is part of the rubric and protects the feedback time of every group — the whole block has no spare minutes.

4. Two-minute feedback format

Feedback is short, specific and kind. It follows the same pattern for every group.

Time	Who	What
0:00–0:45	One peer group (rotating: Group 2 comments on Group 1, Group 3 on Group 2 ... Group 1 on Group 5)	Two stars and a wish: two specific things that were strong, one specific suggestion.
0:45–1:45	Instructor	One strength, the most important improvement for the written proposal or publication plan (usually design, outcome definition, feasibility or choice of journal/guideline), and one question if time allows.
1:45–2:00	Presenting group	One-sentence reply or "thank you, we will take that on board". No defending.

Written feedback: during each presentation, the peer group and the instructors fill in the one-page feedback form at the end of [Proposal_Rubric.pdf](#). Forms are handed to the presenting group at the end of the session so they can revise the written proposal.

Good feedback is... specific ("your exclusion criteria would remove most elderly patients") rather than general ("good job"); about the proposal, not the people; and actionable ("add the time point to your primary outcome").

5. The 1-minute manuscript pitch (end of the block)

After all five proposal presentations, each group's **lead author** (or another member) stands up for **one minute** — no new slides needed; the course lead shows one slide per group with the group number and question number, or the group shows its Table 1 or main figure.

Say three things, in this order:

1. **Question:** "In 600 simulated ICU patients with sepsis, we asked whether ... was associated with ..."
2. **Main result:** the main effect with its 95% CI, crude and adjusted if relevant ("adjusted OR 1.5, 95% CI ...").
3. **One-sentence conclusion** in calibrated language, and the next step (peer-review swap).

The timekeeper shows the red card at 1:00. There is no feedback in the block: feedback on the manuscript comes through the peer-review swap ([Peer_Review_Instructions.pdf](#)) and [Manuscript_Rubric.pdf](#). The pitch is not scored.